

Activity: Match the Boundary Phrase to the Situation

Title: *Say It Your Way: Matching Response, Tone, and Format*

Objective:

Match each **workplace situation** with the most suitable **boundary phrase** based on:

- **Who** is asking
- **How** the message is sent (in person, email, or message)
- **What** tone fits best (direct or softened)

Instructions

1. Read the workplace situations below.
2. Match each one with the best response from the **Phrase Bank**.
3. For each match, decide:
 - Is the tone **direct** or **softened**?
 - What format is this (in person, email, or text/message)?
4. Optional: Rewrite the phrase using your own natural speaking or writing style.

Workplace Situations

1. **Your manager messages you at the end of the day:**
"Can you review this before you leave?"
You are tired and about to log off.
2. **A teammate stops by your desk:**
"Can you take over my meeting tomorrow? I have too much to do."
You are already booked with other tasks.
3. **A work friend texts you at night:**
"I'm nervous about tomorrow's presentation. Can you help me tonight?"
4. **A senior team member sends you an email:**
"Can you lead next week's training session? I forgot to plan it."
You have never led this session before and feel unsure.

5. A colleague you help often calls during your break:

"Can I show you something quickly? I just need your thoughts."

You have a short break but want to support them if possible.

 Phrase Bank (Use each phrase once)

A. *"I want to support you, but I'm finished work for today. If you send it to me, I can look at it first thing tomorrow."*

B. *"Thank you for asking. I already have several responsibilities and cannot take on anything else right now."*

C. *"I don't feel ready to lead this session. Maybe someone with more experience can help?"*

D. *"I'm happy to help, but I only have a short time now. Could we schedule something for tomorrow?"*

E. *"I'm finishing up now. If this is not urgent, I can give it proper attention in the morning."*

Sample Answer Key

Situation	Phrase	Tone	Format
1	E	Softened	Message
2	B	Direct	In person
3	A	Softened	Text
4	C	Direct	Email
5	D	Softened	In person